

ZELIN (RICHARD) ZHU

Chapel Hill, NC | richardrizzling@gmail.com | github.com/ZelinZhu-Richard

EDUCATION

Chapel Hill High School | *Class of 2027, GPA: summa cum laude Chapel Hill, NC | Aug 2023 - May 2027*

Coursework: AP Calculus BC, AP Statistics w/ Calculus, AP Physics C Mechanics, AP Physics C E&M, Multivariable Calculus & Linear Algebra (MIT OCW)

Durham Technical Community College | *Dual Enrollment, GPA: 4.00 Durham, NC | Aug 2025 - May 2027*

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Python, JavaScript/TypeScript, SQL, HTML/CSS **AI/ML:** PyTorch, scikit-learn, TensorFlow, SVM, PCA, Agentic Skills

Web & Tools: React, React Flow, Node.js, Git/GitHub, Google ADK, Claude API, Jupyter, Excel

Other: Bilingual (Mandarin & English), Quantitative Modeling, Data Analysis, Multi-Agent Systems, Public Speaking

EXPERIENCE

MeridianAlgo | *Quant Developer Chapel Hill, NC | Sep 2025 - Present*

Build and maintain Apex Analysis, an open-source ML-powered stock analysis platform with interactive data visualizations and trading tools within a 5-person engineering team.

Develop model training pipelines for equity market prediction and signal generation using Python and scikit-learn

UNC PRIMES | *Scholar Chapel Hill, NC | May 2026 - Present*

Selected for UNC's PROGRAM FOR RESEARCH IN IMAGE PROCESSING AND MACHINE LEARNING FOR EMERGING SCHOLARS. Conduct research around Machine learning and Computer vision.

AI9ha (Nexus Tensor Alpha) | *Founder Chapel Hill, NC | Nov 2025 - Present*

Building an AI-native quantitative trading research project: Mixture-of-Experts forecasting architecture (TFT, MAML, N-BEATS) with regime-aware gating and a multi-LLM agent layer for unstructured signal processing.

PROJECTS

EqualVoice | *Duke SCAI Hackathon, Finalist*

- Captained all-high-school team to finalist, competing against Undergraduate, Graduate, PhD students and professors; built benchmark for evaluating voice-to-text equity across different accents.

Zhu Academy | *AI-Powered Learning Platform*

- Knowledge graph tool (React 18, Vite, React Flow, Claude API) mapping concepts into adaptive learning pathways

Research Email Agent | *Kaggle Capstone, Open-sourced on GitHub*

- Multi-agent pipeline (Google ADK) with Research, Profile, EmailWriter, Validator agents for automated outreach

Wharton HSDSC | *Team Captain / Modeling Lead*

- Multi-model ensemble (Pythagorean Expectation + Bradley-Terry) for ice hockey simulation analysis

LEADERSHIP, COMMUNITY & AWARDS

Honors:

YC AI Startup School: Selected as the Youngest Attendees at the age of 17, Hand picked by YC General Partner, top 5 percent of the applicants out of 50000 ish applicants.

USACO Gold

UNC PRIMES (Accepted)

Duke SCAI Hackathon Finalist

Wharton HSDSC&HSIC Team Captain

Georgia tech statistic and probability competition: Advanced to the top 40 second round and is the captain of the first place winning team.

President, AI Club / CS Club / Research & Innovation Club, Chapel Hill High School

Board Member, Morehead Planetarium Teen Science Café & Museum of Life and Science Teen Advisory Board

Founder, UNA-USA Chapter at CHHS (SDGs 8, 9, 13) | **Organized and led** Durham AI Literacy Workshop; 60+ attendees, sponsored by **Meta** and **Perplexity**.